Precedent

A Smarter Way to Manage Brand Rules and Approvals

Round 1 — The Plan

Inkloom AI Brand Governance Challenge

Team name: `samarth.darak24`
College / Institution: Vishwakarma Institute of Pune
Team leader: Samarth Manojkumar Darak

Our idea in one paragraph. We want to build Precedent, a platform that helps marketing teams check content against brand guidelines before it is published. What makes our approach different is how it handles the situations that guidelines do not explain properly. When a brand manager allows an exception, that decision should not get lost in a chat or email. Precedent will record who made the decision, why it was allowed, where it applies, and when it expires. If the company later changes a rule, our system will show which earlier decisions and content may be affected before the new rule becomes active.

1 Our Understanding of the Problem

When a company works with several employees, designers, freelancers, and agencies, keeping every advertisement consistent becomes difficult. One person may use an old logo, another may write an unsupported product claim, and someone else may follow a guideline that is no longer current. Content can move between emails, messaging apps, shared folders, and different reviewers. By the time a mistake is noticed, the content may already be scheduled or published.

We understand that this challenge is not simply about finding spelling mistakes or checking whether a poster uses the correct color. The real problem is that teams need a dependable way to connect creative work with approved brand rules, product facts, and human decisions. A useful solution must explain what is wrong, point to the rule or evidence behind the finding, suggest a small correction, and keep people in charge of the final approval. It should also support different content versions, roles, comments, and an audit history.

During our planning, we identified a second problem that interests us most: brand guidelines do not answer every real-life situation. A festival campaign might need a special color, or two reviewers might interpret the same rule differently. If the decision is made only in a meeting or chat, the next creator faces the same confusion. Our project focuses on making these decisions clear and reusable without allowing AI to rewrite company policy on its own.

2 Who Faces This Problem?

Our initial target users are small and medium-sized marketing teams and creative agencies that regularly prepare content for different brands. We have chosen this group as a starting point for the prototype, not because we have already proved it is the largest market.

- **Content creators and designers** need to know what is permitted before spending time on revisions.
- **Brand and marketing managers** need to approve work, explain exceptions, and avoid answering the same questions repeatedly.

- **Rule owners, including legal or product teams,** need to settle conflicts and keep approved claims accurate.
- **Agency account managers** need to show clients which version was approved and why.

For example, a designer might use an orange background for a festive campaign even though the brand guide usually requires green. The marketing manager may approve this one exception, but unless it is recorded clearly, the next designer cannot know whether orange is allowed for all campaigns or only this particular festival. That is the type of confusion we want to solve.

3 Our Proposed Solution: Precedent

Precedent is a pre-publication brand review and decision-management platform. It will let a company upload its guidelines, check new content, record human approvals, and manage exceptions in a structured way. Our central idea is simple: **every exception should have a reason and a scope, and every rule change should have a visible consequence.**

We are not planning to replace brand managers with AI. We want to help them make faster and more consistent decisions. The AI will assist with reading documents, finding relevant passages, and drafting explanations. Actual rule activation, exceptions, and final content approvals will remain with authorised users.

3.1 Complete Product Workflow

1. **Set up a brand workspace.** A manager creates an organisation workspace and uploads brand guidelines, approved claims, and other reference documents.
2. **Review extracted rules.** The system suggests structured rules from the documents. A human checks the wording, source, and scope before those rules become active.
3. **Submit content.** A creator pastes advertising copy or uploads supported text-based content for a pre-publication review.
4. **See findings and suggestions.** Precedent highlights possible violations, shows the exact stored guideline passage where available, and suggests minimal changes. Unclear cases are marked for human review rather than treated as proven violations.
5. **Request review or an exception.** A manager can approve a particular version, request edits, or create a narrowly defined exception with a reason, owner, applicable campaign or channel, and expiry date.
6. **Reuse a valid decision.** When similar content is reviewed later, the system checks whether the earlier exception still applies. An expired or out-of-scope exception cannot be reused automatically.
7. **Test proposed policy changes.** Before activating a new rule, a manager can run a simulation against stored sample content and see which earlier review outcomes or exceptions would change.
8. **Keep the record.** Comments, versions, rulings, approvals, and changes are stored in an audit history so the team can understand what happened later.

3.2 A Short Example

Suppose a fictional brand normally allows only green backgrounds. A designer submits a festival campaign with an orange background. Precedent flags the mismatch and points to the existing color rule. The manager decides that orange is acceptable for festival campaigns until the end of December, provided the official green logo is used. That decision is saved as a scoped exception.

A second festival campaign can then be checked against that approved exception. Later, if someone proposes a new rule banning orange in every campaign, the rule simulator will show the conflict with the earlier festival ruling before the change is approved. This is the demonstration we want judges to see.

4 Main Features We Plan to Build

1. **Brand guideline library:** upload, organise, version, and search reference documents and approved facts.
2. **Evidence-linked content review:** identify potential issues and show the relevant source passage instead of giving only a vague score.
3. **Minimal-edit suggestions:** recommend small improvements without changing the creator's main message unnecessarily.
4. **Version-based human approvals:** let reviewers comment, request changes, and approve a specific content version.
5. **Exception rulings:** record a human-approved exception with its reason, owner, scope, effective dates, and expiry.
6. **Rule conflict detection:** identify contradictions between structured rules or between a proposed rule and an existing ruling.
7. **Rule Impact Sandbox:** compare the current and proposed rule sets against stored content to show possible changes before activation.
8. **Audit log and guideline health view:** show past decisions and recurring sources of confusion, such as frequently overridden rules.

For the first working version, we will focus on text and structured brand rules. Basic poster checks may be added if the core workflow is stable. We will not claim that the prototype can understand every visual design choice or guarantee legal compliance.

5 Technology Stack and Technical Approach

We chose technologies that our team can use to build a working web application without creating unnecessary infrastructure.

Technology	Why we plan to use it
React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS	Build a responsive interface for creators, managers, and reviewers, with reusable components and clear review states.
FastAPI (Python)	Build APIs for documents, rules, content reviews, approvals, exceptions, and simulations.
PostgreSQL	Store organisations, users, rules, content versions, rulings, decisions, and audit records reliably.
pgvector (optional for MVP)	Retrieve relevant guideline passages from longer documents when keyword matching is insufficient.
PyMuPDF and python-docx	Extract text from guideline PDFs and Word documents.
One LLM API	Suggest rule fields, identify potentially relevant passages, and draft explanations or minimal edits.
Python rule engine and tests	Apply explicit scope, priority, expiry, and conflict logic in a predictable and testable way.

5.1 How the System Will Work

The React application will communicate with FastAPI. The backend will manage access permissions and save all approved rules and decisions in PostgreSQL. When a creator submits content, the review service will retrieve relevant guideline passages. An LLM can suggest whether a passage is relevant, but the backend will check that any cited passage actually exists. Explicit rule checks, such as an expired exception or prohibited phrase, will be handled by code. Subjective issues such as tone will be labelled as suggestions or sent for human review.

5.2 Our Biggest Technical Challenge

The hardest part is converting ordinary sentences from a brand guide into rules that software can compare. A sentence like "Use our main green in most promotional material" does not explain every exception. We cannot safely assume that AI has understood its full meaning.

To handle this, we plan to represent each rule using fields such as *subject, condition, action, scope, priority, source, and effective date*. The AI may suggest these fields, but a manager must confirm them. Our simulator will work on this verified rule set and replay previously stored content decisions. We will start with about 30–50 example rules for one fictional brand and expand only after testing reliability.

6 What Makes Our Approach Different?

Many brand-management products already provide guideline libraries, AI content checks, and approval workflows. We do not want to present those common features as a new invention. Our approach focuses on the decisions that happen when guidelines are incomplete, exceptions are needed, or policies change.

The main difference is the combination of **scoped human rulings** and a **pre-activation rule simulator**. Rather than simply remembering that a manager once clicked "approve," Precedent will record the conditions under which the approval was given. Rather than immediately applying a changed policy, it will help the manager see which stored examples and exceptions may be affected. This makes the rules themselves easier to manage, not just the content being checked.

We see this as a focused interpretation of the challenge, not a claim that no other product has similar capabilities. Before our final submission, we will verify competitor features and describe our difference carefully.

7 Feasibility and Scope

We know a hackathon is not enough time to build a complete enterprise brand platform. Our priority is a small, reliable workflow that judges can test from beginning to end. We will use fictional brand data to avoid privacy issues and keep the demonstration reproducible.

Must-have scope: organisation workspace, guideline upload, human-confirmed rules, text review with evidence, content versions, manager approval, exception rulings, audit log, and a basic rule simulator.

Only if time allows: image color checks, OCR-based poster review, advanced analytics, multilingual support, and third-party publishing integrations. We will cut these before compromising the core workflow.

We will test the system with a small labelled set of approximately 40 examples covering compliant content, clear violations, exceptions, and borderline cases. We plan to measure correct findings, false positives, citation quality, conflict detection, and whether the simulator correctly predicts changed

outcomes. We will report actual results after implementation rather than promising accuracy numbers now.

8 Development Plan Across All Three Rounds

Round	What we plan to do
Round 1 — Plan	Understand the brief, review existing solutions, speak with 5–10 potential users if possible, define use cases, design the data model and architecture, divide responsibilities, and submit this proposal. No product implementation will be claimed before the official build window.
Round 2 — Build	During the permitted build window, create the web app and APIs, implement guideline upload, text review, evidence links, version-based approvals, audit logs, and basic exception rulings. Test and demonstrate the full creator-to-manager workflow.
Round 3 — Finish	Strengthen conflict detection and the Rule Impact Sandbox, test edge cases, improve usability, document limitations, prepare a clear demonstration, and add optional visual checks only if the core system is dependable.

Our planned three improvements to demonstrate across the build are: (1) evidence-backed and version-specific review, (2) scoped, expiring human rulings, and (3) rule-change impact simulation. The final scope will follow the organisers' exact build dates and deliverables.

9 Team Responsibilities

Our four team members will divide the work as follows. These are our planned responsibilities for the build rounds.

Member	Primary role	Responsibilities
Samarth Manojkumar Darak	Team lead / product	User interviews, problem validation, project coordination, evaluation, presentation.
Balaji Sanjay Chavan	Backend / data	Database, APIs, rule engine, scope checks, simulator, audit records.
Sartha Chandgude Chandgude	Frontend / QA	Creator workspace, review screens, manager dashboard, usability and accessibility.
Palak Chandak	AI / retrieval	Document extraction, retrieval, LLM prompts, citation validation, test cases.

All team members will contribute to testing, documentation, and the final demonstration. We will keep repository history and contribution records during the official development period.

10 Expected Impact

If Precedent works as planned, creators should spend less time guessing what a guideline means, and managers should spend less time repeating the same explanation. Agencies should be able to show clients which version was approved, and brand owners should have a clearer record of why exceptions were allowed. The simulator could also help teams avoid introducing a rule that unexpectedly contradicts previous decisions.

We will evaluate these benefits rather than assume them. For example, we can compare the time taken to review the same sample content manually and with Precedent, count unsupported findings,

and check whether a reviewer can understand the reason for each decision. Our aim is to make the approval process more understandable and consistent while keeping final authority with people.

11 Future Scope After the Event

After the hackathon, we would like to support posters and other visual assets more fully, connect with tools that creators already use, and support multiple brands and languages. Another useful direction would be monitoring approved content when product facts change, so older material can be flagged for reassessment. For regulated industries, we would need stronger policy controls, security reviews, and specialist legal oversight before real deployment.

These are future possibilities, not features we promise to finish during the event.

12 Responsible Use, Privacy, and Competition Rules

We will use fictional sample documents in the demo. For real organisations, we would need workspace-level access controls, safe handling of uploaded material, clear disclosure of any text sent to an external AI provider, and an appropriate retention policy. The system will not silently activate AI-generated rules or grant approvals. Human reviewers will remain responsible for decisions, and the interface will make uncertainty visible.

We understand that the product must be developed within the official build window. Planning and research may be done earlier where allowed, but we will not present earlier implementation as hackathon work. We will disclose major libraries, APIs, templates, reused components, and AI assistance, respect their licences, and retain repository evidence of our work. Every participant will belong to only one team in the event, and we will submit our own work.

13 Team and Participant Details

Official team name (exact spelling): `samarth.darak24`
Event / track: *[Enter event and track]*
College / university: Vishwakarma Institute of Pune
Team leader email: *[Enter email]*
Contact number (if required): +91 9322449155
Repository / demo link (if requested and available): *[Enter link]*

No.	Full legal name for certificate	Role	Contact number
1	Samarth Manojkumar Darak	Team lead / product	+91 9322449155
2	Balaji Sanjay Chavan	Backend / data	+91 8468983617
3	Palak Chandak	AI / retrieval	+91 9156942778
4	Sartha Chandgude Chandgude	Frontend / QA	+91 7038201106

Submission checklist: We will verify the team name, spelling of all certificate names, contact details, required links, and the organiser's final submission instructions before uploading the PDF.

Closing Note

We chose Precedent because we believe brand consistency is not just about catching mistakes. It is also about helping people understand the rules, record reasonable exceptions, and avoid repeating the same confusion. Our goal for this hackathon is to build a focused prototype that proves this workflow can work in practice, with AI as an assistant and people responsible for the final decisions.